

ENVG-B

Normally when you think about night-vision goggles, you think pitch black darkness, with stuff illuminated in green. However, the military have got some new tech to play around with, we mean, to see in the dark with. The Enhanced Night Vision Goggle-Binoculars, or ENVG-B.

These goggles were designed to not only allow soldiers to see in the dark, but to actually see in the dark. They would be able to make out details and discern what it is that they're seeing. As we know, traditional night goggles produced green images (because it was



thought that it was easy to look at green for long periods of time). However, these images were very noisy and lacked contrast, making it difficult to make out what was actually being seen.

The new ENVG-B night vision goggles upgrade the green phosphor tubes to white ones that produce better contrast and brighter images, allowing people to easily discern what's going on in the dark. It's also paired with technology that makes it possible to see through dust and smoke, allowing it to function in various less-than-ideal conditions. The new ENVG-B even works when there's no external illumination.



Bose SoundControl wearables

Bose is working on hearing aids for the first time. The company announced SoundControl wearables, which it says are the world's first FDA-cleared hearing aids which can be sold directly to customers. What that means is that you don't need to visit a doctor or get a prescription in order to get your hands on one of these hearing aids. The wearables work around Bose's CustomTune feature in the companion mobile app, which allows personalisation of volume levels, tone, treble and bass for your ears. You can magnify quieter sounds, highlight voices, and even make the wearables concentrate on specific areas; so you can set it to focus on sounds from the front when you're in a conversation for example. Bose also mentioned that you can schedule free video appointments if you need help. For now, Bose SoundControl will only be available in Massachusetts, Montana, the Carolinas and Texas for \$850. Bose isn't the only one getting into hearing aids from the looks of it, Jabra and Sennheiser have also taken steps into the industry.

USB-C Type 2.1

The new USB-C cable specification which has been under development for over two years has been released. The biggest change between the current Type-C 2.0 and the new 2.1 is the maximum voltage. With Type 2.1, the max voltage has been pushed up to 48V, meaning it can deliver 240W at 5A. This is significant because it means that even beefier laptops can now switch to USB-C for their charging needs, standardising the cable for laptops. However, more power-hungry laptops will still probably need their own chargers, or work in low-performance mode. On the surface, it doesn't look like much has changed, but on the inside, stricter standards on the midplate means that pins A4-A9 and B4-B9, which handle power, power delivery, and legacy USB 2.0 support, must not short to ground during connector mating.

